



Hands of Change

with understanding comes mastery



www.jasfoundation.co.za



[j-a-s-foundation](https://www.linkedin.com/company/j-a-s-foundation)



[@J.A.S.Foundation](https://www.youtube.com/channel/UCJASFoundation)

A dream that grew into a foundation

On Sunday 18 August 2024, Karrima Nortje, Tahirih Michot and jasmin nordien hosted an intimate gathering in Karrima's home; to share their vision and launched a new initiative called JAS Foundation, to honour the lives and work of their mothers: **Jean Nortje**, **Amina Nordien**, and **Shelly** (Rochelle Cook).

The vision: to promote healing modalities and build capacity of local practitioners to enable well-being and health in poor and disadvantaged communities.

At JAS Foundation, we believe that **dreams** are the blueprint, and

ACTION is the bricks and mortar;
and 'someday' is not a day of the week.

So we got to work, plotting and planning, working hard; and the Hands of Change programme started to take shape. The first cohort (2025) was selected, the training began, the clinic grew, and the programme took on a life of its own.

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Bowen Practitioner's Course 2025



2025 Cohort, six trainees completed their intensive one-year programme, to graduate on 20 November 2025, as internationally certified Bowen Practitioners. The graduates are:

- Cheryll Bachus - community service at Babsie's Health & Fitness (Elsies River).
- Khalida Speck - community services at Sisters Incorporated, women's shelter (Kenilworth).
- Leila Nortje - community service with Beitul Aman, home for the aged (Wynberg).
- Moerieda Theunisseun - community service at mu'alima Sumaya McKnight's Islamic school (Manenberg).
- Nabeelah Omar - community service at Babsie's Health & Fitness (Elsies River).
- Sharron Marco-Thyse - community services at Sisters Incorporated, women's shelter (Kenilworth), and she ran a community clinic at Monica's Place (Grassy Park & Muizenberg).





Bowen Practitioner's Course 2026

2026 Cohort, eight trainees started the second Bowen Practitioner course in January 2026. The trainees are:

- Aqeelah Abrahams (Ottery)
- Fouzia Jardien (Manenberg)
- Hayley English (Belhar)
- Hombakazi Zide (Sis Baba) (Mandalay)
- Joleen Vergotine (Elsies River)
- Khanyiswa Kuse (Guguletu)
- Lindiwe Lengs (Delft)
- Melaney Faure (Hanover Park)



Advance Bowen Course 2026

2026 Cohort, three trainees start the one-year Advance Bowen course in February 2026. The trainees are:

- Cheryll Bachus
- Khalida Speck
- Sharron Marco-Thyse



Last Saturday of each Month
from 9am

**JAS FOUNDATION
MONTHLY CLINIC**

Bowen Therapy to address pain, body alignment, and help activate the body's self-healing ability

www.jasfoundation.co.za

**J.A.S
FOUNDATION**

EVERY BODY MATTERS

Clinics



JAS Foundation Monthly Clinic

The JAS Foundation runs a free monthly clinic in Bridgetown, Athlone at Al Waagah Institute for the Deaf, on the last Saturday of each month, from 9h00 until 16h00.

Community Service Clinics

Organised and managed by JAS Foundation trainees and Practitioners during 2025:

- Elsies River - Babsie's Health & Fitness Centre
- Wynberg - Beitul Aman Home for the Aged
- Manenberg - Madrassa tul Umahaad
- Grassy Park - Monica's Place
- Kenilworth - Sisters Incorporated, women's shelter.

Celeste Solomons,
Social Worker - Sisters Incorporated
(CARING FOR SURVIVORS OF ABUSE)

"It has been such a blessing to have encountered, experienced and hosted both Sharron and Khalida. Forward may this initiative flourish!"



Jean Nortje

JAS Foundation, Leadership

The Founders of the JAS Foundation (Karrima, Tahirih & jasmin) nominated Jean

Nortje as President for Life, and invited Belinda Palmer to join the Leadership Team. In late 2025, Tahirih moved on to other adventures.

JAS Foundation now welcomes two new directors to join our leadership team..

Connie Formson is currently leading the work on Farmer Seed Enterprises at Oxfam in the Netherlands. Prior to Oxfam she worked with a number of NGOs and within the UN system on various programs focused on poverty reduction, economic development, social protection and community resilience. She has an M.A. in Development Economics from the Erasmus University's International Institute of Social Studies in The Hague, The Netherlands



Sharron Marco-Thyse is foremost a human rights activist passionate about issues affecting women, youth and the rural poor. She actively promotes processes that creates an enabling environment for betterment of marginalized communities through policy and legislative changes... "Expertise in strategic management, gender rights, rural development and agriculture, I strive to empower stakeholders."

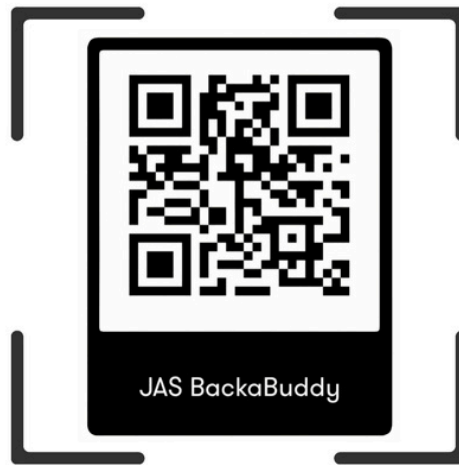


Together, Connie and Sharron bring a wealth of knowledge and experience into the JAS Foundation leadership team. And, we welcome their fresh perspective, to help the JAS Foundation evolve and reach its vision and goals.



Back a Buddy Campaign

TO SUPPORT COMMUNITY HEALTH



The JAS Foundation is currently sustained by individual donations, clinic clients' donations, and volunteers offering their skill and time.

A Back-a-Buddy campaign (organisational and individual) was started in October 2025 to raise funds to support the Foundation's work.

Help the JAS Foundation train Bowen Practitioners and run Clinics in disadvantaged communities across the Western Cape. To support, the link is <https://backabuddy.co.za/campaign/jas-foundation>

Acknowledgements / Thank You

- Csaba Sandberg for website development and technical support.
- Dr. Donna Andrews for assisting with the 2026 Cohort graduation.
- Ronel Stevens and Mosaic for offering the graduation venue and support.
- Sharron Marco-Thyse for helping with administration support and systems development.



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Bowen has changed my life. I can stand up straight. My body works and I don't feel pain. I can care for my children and work well. I have regained my dignity.

Client Testimonial



Health and Healing

Reminder: Medical referral were appropriate.

Physical healing is a fascinating biological "construction project." When your body is mending, it isn't just sitting idle; it's actually working overtime to knit tissues back together

The Three Pillars of Recovery, essentials for an efficient recovery

- **Nutrition** - Your body needs raw materials (protein, vitamins) to build new cells. (Focus on "repair foods" like proteins, leafy greens, and berries.)
- **Sleep** - This is when growth hormones are released to repair muscle and bone. (Aim for 7–9 hours; your body does its best work while you're "offline.")
- **Blood Flow** - Oxygen and nutrients are delivered to the injury site via the blood. (If cleared by a professional, gentle movement or heat can help circulation.)

Signs of Progress (Beyond just "less pain")

- **Increased Range of Motion:** You can move a bit further than yesterday.
- **Reduced Swelling:** The "puffiness" is subsiding, meaning the acute inflammatory phase is ending.
- **Improved Sleep Quality:** Pain isn't waking you up as frequently.

Selfcare



Find the body parts written below in the crossword grid

P	E	Y	E	A	C	F	O	G	R
M	S	T	V	K	B	L	I	P	S
A	C	H	I	N	S	U	M	T	N
F	J	E	S	O	Q	Z	A	K	E
H	A	N	D	S	W	N	I	D	C
E	J	K	A	E	P	T	S	C	K
D	G	O	I	R	E	A	R	S	U
A	R	M	F	X	A	I	M	D	K
B	Y	H	E	J	L	F	E	E	T
S	T	O	M	A	C	H	Z	C	G



FEET

EYE

LIPS

HANDS

NOSE



EARS

ARM

NECK

STOMACH

CHIN



Take a moment to breathe deeply




J.A.S.
FOUNDATION

2025/6
PRACTITIONERS
LIST

The Bowen Technique

Sharron Marco-Thyse [Plumstead]	082 490 3675
Khalida Speck [Plumstead]	083 310 1369
Cheryll Bachus [Kenwyn]	074 333 1987
Nabeelah Omar [Ottery]	079 512 6644
Moerieda Theunisseun [Manenberg]	073 002 9331
Leila Nortje [Bergvliet]	076 488 0936

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